

Minutes of the Meeting

between

cCauvery, IISc Bengaluru Team and Advanced Centre for Integrated Water Resources Management (ACIWRM)

Meeting Date: 16-03-2026

Meeting Time: 03:00 PM – 04:30 PM

Meeting Venue: ACIWRM 1/1, First Floor, KSFC Bhavan, Thimmaiah Road, near
Cantonment Railway Station, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560052, India

Meeting Attendees:

Attendees	Designation
Dr. P. S. Rao	Director (Technical), ACIWRM, GoK
Mr. Rajesh K	Registrar and Engineer in Chief, ACIWRM, GoK
Dr. Sashikumar N	Water Resources Specialist, ACIWRM, GoK
Ms. Hafeezunnisa	Asst. Registrar/Asst. Executive Engineer, ACIWRM, GoK
Dr. Usha Aswathaiah	River Basin Management Specialist, ACIWRM, GoK
Prof. Praveen C Ramamurthy	Professor, ICWaR, IISc Bengaluru
Dr. Rajarshi Das Bhowmik	Assistant Professor, ICWaR, IISc Bengaluru
Dr. Suyog Gupta	Research Associate, ICWaR, IISc Bengaluru
Ms. Nruthya K	Senior Research Fellow, ICWaR, IISc Bengaluru

1. Opening Remarks

- Prof. Praveen C. Ramamurthy initiated the meeting and provided an overview of the cCauvery project, including its objectives, mission, and ongoing activities.

2. Technical Discussions and Inputs from ACIWRM

- Dr. P. S. Rao informed that ACIWRM has previously worked on:
 - Inflow forecasting and reservoir operations in collaboration with IIT Kharagpur.
 - Hydrological forecasting in collaboration with IIT Gandhinagar.
However, these systems are currently not operational.
 - He also mentioned that two WRD, GoK-sponsored M.Tech students from IISc, Sunil is working on a hydrological model for the Hemavathi basin. Nisha is

working on streamflow drought forecasting for the Cauvery basin. ACIWRM expressed interest in integrating these model outputs into their platform.

3. Infrastructure and Monitoring Systems

- Dr. Sashikumar N. highlighted that Rubicon has set up a SCADA system, which is currently remotely operated. However, its efficiency could be improved if made fully operational and optimized.

4. Progress Updates on cCauvery

- Dr. Suyog presented updates on:
 - Submitted reports under cCauvery tasks.
 - Ongoing work and identified data gaps.

5. Data Availability and Challenges

- Dr. P. S. Rao emphasized that:
 - Several required datasets for cCauvery are either not being measured or have significant gaps.
 - Dynamic datasets may require validation by WRD, GoK.
 - Demand estimation varies across organizations due to differing methodologies.
 - Source-of-supply data is incomplete, especially due to unreported groundwater usage.

6. Data Sources and Institutional Linkages

- Suggested sources for data collection:
 - Groundwater Authority for industrial water usage approvals.
 - District Industries Centre (located at the District Collector's Office).
 - Agriculture Department for historical water requirement data (contact: Shri Y.S.Patil, IAS., Commissioner for Agriculture, Department of Agriculture, Government of Karnataka).
 - E-Governance Department (Dr. Manoj Rajan, CEO, Centre for e Governance, Government of Karnataka).

- Agriculture Department office (opposite SJP College) for fertilizer subsidy-related datasets.
- Recommendation to use remote sensing for estimating agricultural water demand.

7. Water Quality and Monitoring

- ACIWRM has installed four water quality sensors in the Tungabhadra river basin.
- Opportunities identified for pollution source mapping under the cCauvery project.

8. Ongoing and Related Initiatives

- Dr. P. S. Rao highlighted the “Healthy Rivers Initiative” (e.g., DRMP/Nirmal Dhara), with increasing public engagement through ACIWRM.
- Dr. Rajarshi Das Bhowmik indicated that hydrological modelling will likely be conducted using the SWAT model.
- Reference was made to ongoing work on the Arkavathi River led by Mr. K Jaiprakash (Technical Advisor to Deputy CM GoK).

9. Data on Soil and Geology

- Soil data sources:
 - ICAR–NBSS&LUP (also shared with the REWARD project).
 - Karnataka State Remote Sensing Applications Centre (KSRSAC).
- Geological data:
 - Department of Mines and Geology (noting that changes are mainly in arsenic- and fluoride-affected regions).

10. Strategic Directions

- It was emphasized that DRMP activities should be aligned with ACIWRM initiatives.
- The Chief Secretary has shown interest in making datasets publicly accessible.
- ACIWRM expressed strong interest in incorporating pollution assessment components for the Cauvery basin.

11. Closing Remarks with Research and Collaboration Opportunities

- Prof. Praveen C. Ramamurthy discussed the potential use of bio-indicators for river pollution assessment.
- Karnataka Engineering Research Station, Mysuru, is currently engaged in related modelling work.
- The possibility of establishing an MoU for Ph.D. admissions through ICWaR was discussed as a step towards strengthening long-term research collaboration.